

available hard drive called ProFile was sold by Apple in 1981 for \$3500 – that's \$700 per GB!

While hard drives became popular for widespread use in computers and later as external data storage devices, it may be news to you that even calculators, cash registers and VHS machines utilise hard drives to store varying amounts of data. This device is important because the size and speed of the hard drive in a system is directly proportional to how efficient the system will be.



What makes hard drives revolutionary is their infinite ability to be rewritten unlike traditional storage devices such as disks and tapes. Because the information is stored magnetically all the data can be rearranged, changed and moved around without disruption or loss of data. It actually took 51 years since the hard drive was first invented for disks to reach a capacity of 1 terabyte. This happened in 2007. Following shortly was the first 2TB storage hard drive in 2009. One can only wonder what the next level of storage will be and how soon it will come to the market.

Harnessed Electricity

Electricity as a potent force has been looked at in wonder since time immemorial. Even in ancient times there are records of wool being rubbed to generate a spark of static electricity. But the history of electricity being used as a viable energy source is a chequered one. In 1752, Benjamin Franklin conducted the famous kite experiment to show that lightning is indeed electricity. Towards the end of the 18th century Galvani discovered bio-electricity and even inspired the now famous Frankenstein legend. But the idea of harnessing electricity can be traced back to Faraday's seminal work in inventing the electric motor in 1821 and Faraday disk in 1931. But the principle of converting current to mechanical force and vice versa couldn't have been possible without discoveries made by André-Marie Ampère and Alessandro Volta (Notice their names). In experimenting